

# Next-Action Selection Under Defective Inputs

The assistant first decides what kind of repair, if any, is needed before generating a response.

## User input + optional evidence

### Answerable control

What county is Old Forge, New York in?

Supported answer exists

### False premise

Why did Marie Curie win the Nobel Prize in Literature?

Premise should be corrected

### Stale premise

Why is Facebook still trading under FB?

Outdated premise

### Conflicting evidence

Passage A says 1890; Passage B says 1902.

Support may be irreconcilable

## Choose the highest-utility next action

action before generation

Answer generation is downstream of action choice.

## Response behavior

### answer

Provide the supported answer directly.

### ask

Ask the minimum useful follow-up question.

### challenge

Correct the false or stale premise first.

### abstain

Explain why support is insufficient or conflicting.